

EVICTIION PROCESS — FL

For: Maria Elena Rodriguez

Understanding the process reduces fear and helps you prepare. This is a general timeline — your specific dates are on your summons.

1. Notice to Pay or Quit *(3-15 days)*

Landlord gives you written notice. You have this many days to pay or move out.

2. Eviction Complaint Filed *(After notice expires)*

Landlord files complaint with the court. You will be served with a summons.

3. File Your Answer *(5 business days)*

YOU ARE HERE. You must file a written response within 5 business days of being served.

4. Rent Deposit to Court Registry *(Same as answer)*

If you raise any defense, you must deposit rent with the court clerk.

5. Hearing / Trial *(Usually 2-4 weeks)*

Judge hears both sides. Bring all evidence. Decision may be same day.

6. Judgment *(Day of hearing)*

If you lose, the judge issues a Final Judgment for Eviction.

7. Writ of Possession *(24-48 hours after judgment)*

Sheriff posts a 24-hour notice on your door. You must vacate immediately.

IMPORTANT: This timeline is a general guide. Your specific deadlines and procedures depend on your state, county, and case type. Read your summons carefully. If you do not understand something, ask the court clerk or a legal aid attorney.